
**Unit 1, Option E/F,
Topic E/F3: The
Collapse of the
Liberal State and
the Triumph of
Fascism in Italy,
1896-1943**

The main focus of this topic is on the rise of Fascism in the years to 1922, the ways in which the Fascist Party established itself in power in Italy in the years 1922–25, and the nature of the Fascist regime to 1943. Since the focus of Unit 1 is on broad themes, questions will not be set which concentrate exclusively on depth of knowledge, for example about one particular individual or event, other than those which are specifically listed in the content bullet points. Students will, however, be expected to demonstrate their understanding of the themes defined in the content bullet points by the selection and deployment of relevant information as exemplification.

The bullet points should not each be considered in isolation. Collectively they support the key themes of the: the nature and impact of Italian Fascism, the reasons for its rise, and the extent of its success. Students will need to address the links between different areas to understand and make judgements on these issues.

The first bullet point in the specification relates to the problems facing Italy before 1914. Students should understand situation in 1896, the nature of the political system and economic problems, the impact of the north/south divide and the cultural variations that undermined unity. They should also be aware of Italy's relative weakness as a great power, the impact on nationalist aspirations, how attempts by Giolitti to reform the political system allowed these frustrations to be expressed and how discontent was manifested in the period before the First World War.

The second bullet point focuses on the impact of the First World War in Italy. Students should understand why entry into the war was divisive and its outcome disappointing. They should be able to account for the weakness of the liberal state, drawing, for example, on: the economic impact of war and the handling of post-war problems by the Liberal governments; the impact of the 'mutilated victory' and the ensuing problems over Fiume; and the impact on different parties of the democratic reforms of 1919. The phrase 'Mussolini, the message and appeal of Fascism, 1919-22' encompasses ideology and tactics, the role of Mussolini as leader and of his links with other groups, institutions and individuals. Questions will not be asked that require specific knowledge of particular events and individuals, but students do need to be able to exemplify Fascist support.

The third bullet point focuses on the development of the Fascist state. Students should understand the consolidation of Fascist power in 1922-25, the use of propaganda, education and censorship in order to secure consent and control, and the use of terror and repression, in particular the role of the special police force (OVRA). They should have knowledge of Fascist relations with the industrial and agricultural elites, of economic policies including the 'battles' for grain and births, and the extent to which they were successful in either political or economic terms. Students should also have knowledge of relations with the king, with other parties such as the nationalists, with the army and with the Church, including the nature and significance of the Lateran Treaties.

The final bullet point relates to Italian foreign policy after 1922, with particular emphasis on Abyssinia, Spain and Germany. Students should understand the aims of Mussolini's foreign policy and the ways in which foreign affairs and events, such as the annexation of Fiume and the bombardment of Corfu, were used for internal political purposes. They should understand how foreign affairs contributed to Mussolini's success and ultimately to his fall, drawing on his policies relating to Abyssinia, Spain and Germany and on Italy's role in the war to 1943. Questions will not be set which require detailed knowledge of military campaigns or on relations with other powers.

**Unit 1, Option E/
F, Topic E/F4:
Republicanism,
Civil War and
Francoism in Spain,
1931-75**

The main focus of this topic is on the causes, nature and significance of the Spanish Civil War, and its role in the development of modern Spain. Since the focus of Unit 1 is on broad themes, questions will not be set which concentrate exclusively on depth of knowledge, for example about one particular individual or event, other than those which are specifically listed in the content bullet points. Students will, however, be expected to demonstrate their understanding of the themes defined in the content bullet points by the selection and deployment of relevant information as exemplification.

The bullet points should not each be considered in isolation. Students should be aware of links between them, for example the effect of underlying attitudes (bullet 1) on the nature, impact and aftermath of the war (bullets 3 and 4) as well as its causes (bullet 2). Collectively, the bullet points offer a framework for understanding the focus of the topic and should be utilised together for that purpose.

The first bullet point is focused on the underlying causes of civil war. Students should understand Spain's economic and cultural backwardness, the reasons for popular discontent and the strength of conservative influences, including the Church and army. In this context they should have knowledge of the years of republican rule, reform and reaction, and the increasing atmosphere of violence before the victory of the Popular Front in 1936. They should also be aware of the mistakes made by the republicans, the internal divisions of the left, and the extent to which they contributed to the weakness of republican government in 1936.

The second bullet point is focused on the outbreak of civil war. Students should have knowledge of the trigger to war in the murder of Sotelo and the beginning of revolt in Morocco. They should understand the role of the generals and have knowledge of Franco, including his role in the suppression of the 1934 rising in the Asturias. They should have knowledge of the extent and nature of support for both sides at the beginning of the war and of the impact of regional loyalties within Spain, the balance of military advantage and experience and how it favoured the right. Questions will not be asked that require detailed knowledge of particular events and individuals but students should be able to describe and exemplify the broad categories involved.

The third bullet point is focused on the nature and course of the war, and the reasons for nationalist success. Students should be aware of the impact of atrocities committed by both sides. They should have outline knowledge of the main campaigns, the stages by which the nationalists extended their territory, and the fall of both Barcelona and Madrid in 1939. They should be able to explain the role of Franco and of internal divisions on the republican side. They should have knowledge of foreign intervention, the roles of Russia, Italy and Germany, the nature of French and British 'non-intervention', and the extent of aid given to both sides and its effect on the outcome of the war. Questions will not be asked that focus on events outside Spain.

The final bullet point is focused on Franco's rule after 1939 and the legacy of the war. Students should be aware of: the nature and extent of repression through military courts; mass executions and the role of the police; the use of censorship; the role of the Falange; and state intervention in economic and social relationships. They should understand the role and independence of the Church. They should also be aware of Franco's ability to maintain neutrality, both for his own benefit and that of Spain, and of the gradual relaxation of controls, the economic benefits conferred by state intervention, and improving conditions by the 1960s. They should understand the nature of Franco's provision for a successor and the role of Juan Carlos to 1975.

**Unit 1, Option E/
F, Topic E/F5:
Germany Divided
and Reunited,
1945-91**

The main focus of this topic is on the process of division and eventual re-unification of Germany after 1945. Since the focus of this unit is on broad themes, questions will not be set which concentrate exclusively on depth of knowledge, for example about one particular individual or event, other than those which are specifically listed in the content bullet points. Students will, however, be expected to demonstrate their understanding of the themes defined in the content bullet points by the selection and deployment of relevant information as exemplification.

The content bullet points should not each be considered in complete isolation from one another and students should develop an appreciation of links between them. For example, the importance of external influences in creating partition (bullet 1) helps to explain both popular support and the role of German politicians in bringing about re-unification (bullet 4) as well as the importance of Gorbachov in enabling it. Students should be aware of these links, which enable them to understand the key themes of an imposed partition, contrasting development and growing pressure for re-unification, and that the bullet points collectively offer a framework for understanding the process.

The first bullet point in the specification relates to the emergence of two German states as a result of defeat and division in 1945. Students should understand the reasons for and the process of partition. They could refer to growing hostility between the Allies in 1945-46, the Truman doctrine and the impact of the Marshall plan, the development of two currencies in 1948, the Berlin Crisis, and the establishment of two German states in 1949. Questions will not be asked about events outside Germany but students will need to be aware of Cold War attitudes and the context of international rivalry in order to understand how two Germanys emerged without direct reference to the German people.

The second bullet point is focused on economic development in the two states and the political impact of the growing contrast. Students need to be aware of the impact of foreign aid in West Germany, the economic 'miracle', the Common Market and the effect on living standards. They also need to understand the extent of Russian control over German Democratic Republic, the roles of Cominform and Comecon, and the extent to which German resources and markets were managed for the benefit of the Soviet Union. Growing problems in East Germany can be exemplified by tensions over Berlin and the building of the Berlin Wall in 1961. The impact in East Germany can also be developed by reference to political repression, the role of the Stasi, and the continued presence of Russian troops to support the East German government.